DAVID PARK PHD · EVIDENCE-BASED ENTREPRENEURSHIP · FREE WORKSHEET

What Has to Be True? Worksheet

VIDEO 1

Write down what a business depends on, and see which parts you know and which you only believe.

From the video "Is Your Business Idea a Good Opportunity?"

HOW TO USE THIS SHEET

1. Pick a business you know. A café on your corner, a company you'd like to work for, or your own idea.
2. For each of the five questions, write what would have to be true for it to work.
3. For each claim, note how good it looks and how you know. Circle the ones you actually know, as opposed to believe.
4. Star the one claim that would most change your mind if it turned out to be false.

The business

The business in one line What it is and who it is for

What would have to be true

The first letters spell MERIT. Circle each claim you know, and star the one that would most change your mind.

Question	What would have to be true	How good does it look?	How do you know?
Market. Do enough people want it, badly enough?			
Edge. Why would they pick yours over what they do now?			
Returns. Will it make enough money to be worth it?			
Implementation. Can you build it and deliver it?			
Team. Are you the right people to do it?			

Your starred claim

The claim that would most change your mind Copy it from the table

How could you find out, cheaply? Something you could do this week, before you spend real money

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE

A corner café. People nearby want good coffee here, and you've seen the line every morning, so you circle it. Good baristas can be hired, and the café down the street has kept its staff for years, so you circle that too. They'd choose it over the chain is the one you only believe, and it would change your mind most, so it gets the star. The idea itself, a café, is the least interesting thing on the page.

THE TRAP

Confidence feels the same from the inside whether you know something or only believe it, so write down how you know, not how sure you feel.

WHY THIS WORKS

MERIT borrows from research-tested frameworks, but it hasn't been validated as a predictive model. Use it to decide what to check, not to predict who will succeed.

Next video: Find the Problem People Are Already Trying to Fix

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